

WONDERFULLY MADE LABS

For the Restless · Anger, Frustration & the Noise of the Digital Age

# Still

*"Be still, and know that I am God." — Psalm 46:10*

A guided faith journal for finding peace in a loud, restless world.

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## A NOTE BEFORE YOU BEGIN

This journal was written for the tiredness that sleep doesn't seem to fix.

Maybe you know it. Small things set you off more than they should. You reach for your phone to unwind and set it down more restless than before. The days run together, loud and fast, and quiet feels harder to find than it used to.

That is not a personal failing. It is what happens to people made for stillness who are living in a world built to keep them from it.

Here is the heart of these pages: we are not meant to fix our own restlessness by force. The more we strive for peace, the further it seems to get. Real peace comes a different way — by turning to God, honestly and empty-handed, and letting Him restore what the noise has worn down. That is an old promise, and it still holds: God takes people who are worn out and makes them new.

This is six short parts to help you find your way back to that quiet. Names and credentials do not matter here — only His do. And every “my” in these pages is meant to become “ours,” because none of us were built to carry this alone.

PART ONE

# The Noise

## When the world is too loud

> *"Be still, and know that I am God." — Psalm 46:10*

It is worth being clear-eyed about what we are up against. The technology in our pockets was designed to keep us scrolling, comparing, and stirred up. It promised connection and often delivers comparison. It promised information and often delivers exhaustion. This is not a fair fight, and most of us lose it many times a day without noticing.

So it is no surprise that peace feels out of reach. The problem is not weakness. The problem is that we keep trying to win on our own strength.

God's first word to a restless mind is not “try harder.” It is “be still.” Not as a reward once we have calmed down — as the very way the calm begins. And it begins with the humility to admit we cannot manufacture it ourselves.

### REFLECT — HONEST QUESTIONS, NOT EASY ONES

- What is the first thing I reach for in the morning? What does that reveal about where I look for peace?
- When I pick up my phone to relax, what am I actually looking for? Does it deliver?
- Why does the idea of ten still, screen-free minutes feel so difficult?

### WRITE

Describe the loudest part of your day — not the busiest, the loudest. The part that leaves your mind buzzing afterward. Just get it onto the page.

PART TWO

# The Anger

## When you're more frustrated than you want to be

> *"Be angry and do not sin; do not let the sun go down on your anger." — Ephesians 4:26*
> *"Everyone should be quick to listen, slow to speak and slow to become angry." — James 1:19*

Much of modern frustration is low-grade and constant — the traffic, the inbox, the meeting that went nowhere, the work that takes more than it gives. It rarely gets named. It simply accumulates, and over time it can quietly harden a person.

Scripture treats anger with real wisdom. It is not the enemy; it is information. It signals that something we value is being stepped on — our time, our dignity, our sense of what is fair. We are never told to feel nothing. We are told not to let anger own us, and not to carry it into tomorrow, because anger we refuse to set down tends to take root.

And we are not left to manage it alone by sheer willpower. It can be brought to God — honestly — and slowly softened by Him.

### REFLECT — HONEST QUESTIONS, NOT EASY ONES

- What am I actually frustrated about lately? Not the surface thing — the thing beneath it.
- Is there anger I have carried past sundown, perhaps for a long time? What has holding it cost me?
- What is my frustration trying to protect? What do I fear I will lose if I set it down?

### WRITE

Name the frustration you have been carrying without saying out loud. Write it plainly. You do not have to solve it here — simply stop pretending it isn't there, and begin to hand it over.

PART THREE

# The Impatience

## When you can't stand the waiting

> *"Wait for the Lord; be strong and take heart and wait for the Lord." — Psalm 27:14*
> *"They who wait for the Lord shall renew their strength; they shall mount up with wings like eagles." — Isaiah 40:31*

Our screens have trained us to expect everything immediately — answers, replies, deliveries, results. So when life asks us to wait — on a decision, on healing, on a difficult season to turn, on a new opportunity — the waiting itself can feel like failure, or like God has gone quiet.

Scripture sees waiting differently. Not as wasted time, but as the very place where strength is renewed. The waiting is not the obstacle to growth. Often, the waiting is where the growth happens — and where God does the work that a quick answer never could.

### REFLECT — HONEST QUESTIONS, NOT EASY ONES

- What am I waiting on right now that I find hard to bear?
- Where has impatience pushed me into a word or decision I later regretted?
- What might God be doing in me during this wait that He could not do if the answer came instantly?

### WRITE

Write about the thing you are waiting on. Then, underneath it, one line: “While I wait, I will trust Him to…” — and finish it with something small and true.

PART FOUR

# The Work

## When your job takes more than it gives

> *"Come to me, all who labor and are heavy laden, and I will give you rest." — Matthew 11:28*
> *"Whatever you do, work heartily, as for the Lord and not for men." — Colossians 3:23*

For many of us, the restlessness lives in our work. The striving. The comparison. The quiet dread on a Sunday evening. The sense of running hard and arriving nowhere. Some are between jobs and feel the sting of every silence. Some are in a role they have outgrown and feel stuck. And many of us, at some point, quietly let our sense of worth become wired into what we do for a living — until something reminds us it was never meant to carry that weight.

Christ does not say, "prove yourself, and then you may rest." He says "come to me… and I will give you rest." Rest first. Worth first — settled and secure, not up for daily negotiation. Good work is meant to flow out of a soul at peace, not to be the thing we exhaust ourselves trying to earn peace from.

### REFLECT — HONEST QUESTIONS, NOT EASY ONES

- What is my work actually costing me — in peace, in presence, in health?
- Where have I let my job become the voice that tells me whether I matter?
- If my worth were fully settled — nothing left to prove — how would I show up to work tomorrow?

### WRITE

Write down where you honestly are with work right now — the frustration and the hope both. Then write: "My worth is not in this. My worth is in the One who made me."

PART FIVE

# The Return

## Coming back to the Word

> *"Your word is a lamp to my feet and a light to my path." — Psalm 119:105*
> *"In me you may have peace. In the world you will have tribulation. But take heart; I have overcome the world." — John 16:33*

There is a kind of quiet no screen can offer — the quiet that comes from setting the noise down and picking the Word up. And it is worth saying clearly: this is not one more task to feel behind on. It is not a performance. It is a homecoming.

You do not have to read for an hour. You do not have to understand everything at once. You simply have to come — the way you would step to a window to feel the sun. A single verse, read slowly, can do more for a restless mind than an hour of scrolling ever will.

### REFLECT — HONEST QUESTIONS, NOT EASY ONES

- When did I last sit with Scripture and genuinely feel it slow me down?
- What keeps me from returning to it — time, guilt, distraction, or something I have not named?
- Which verse in these pages could I carry into tomorrow, like a stone in my pocket?

### WRITE

Copy out, by hand, the one verse in this journal that met you most. Handwriting slows the mind in a way typing does not. Then write why it reached you.

PART SIX

# The Stillness

## Practicing peace on purpose

> *"You keep him in perfect peace whose mind is stayed on you, because he trusts in you." — Isaiah 26:3*
> *"The peace of God, which surpasses all understanding, will guard your hearts and your minds in Christ Jesus." — Philippians 4:7*

Peace, it turns out, is less something we find once and more something we practice. The world will not grow quieter. The notifications will not stop. So stillness has to be chosen — deliberately, daily — as a small act of trust that says, "I cannot make peace on my own, but I know Who can, and I am turning to Him again."

That is the shape of being made new: not a single dramatic fix, but a steady series of returns to the same source. We will drift back into the noise. The invitation, every time, is the same — come back, and be still.

The Stillness Practice (ninety seconds, no screen): 1) Put the phone in another room, or face-down and silenced. 2) Breathe in slowly, and pray: "Be still…" 3) Breathe out slowly, and finish it: "…and know that You are God." 4) Repeat, unhurried, until your shoulders drop. 5) Read one verse. Just one. Let it be enough.

### REFLECT — HONEST QUESTIONS, NOT EASY ONES

- Where in my day could I plant ninety seconds of chosen stillness?
- What keeps telling me I have to keep striving? Is it true?
- What would change if I truly believed God's peace could guard my mind — even here, even now?

### WRITE

Write the one sentence you most need to hear from God tonight. Then read it back slowly, as if He were saying it to you — because in His Word, He is.

## A CLOSING WORD

You picked this up because something in you is weary of the noise. That weariness is not weakness. It is your soul telling the truth: you were made for a stillness, and a peace, this world cannot manufacture — no matter how many times the screen refreshes.

And that peace does not come from trying harder. It comes the way renewal always comes — by turning to the Lord with open hands and letting Him restore what has been worn down. That is the promise, and it is for you: He takes what is tired and frayed and makes it new.

This is a practice, not a one-time cure. The restlessness may return. But you no longer have to face it on your own strength — and neither does anyone you might share this with.

Take this journal freely. Return to it whenever the world gets loud. And when the peace comes — and it will — you will know exactly Who to thank.

*To God be all the glory. In the name of the Father, Son, and Holy Spirit. Amen.*

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